airguides

PRIVATE SMALL-VESSEL EXPEDITION

Antarctica: Wildlife of the White Continent

Twenty-seven nights aboard Meridian with wildlife photographer Martin Gregus, a flexible route and only 12 guests.

DATES	DURATION	GROUP SIZE	TRIP PRICE
27 November - 24 December 2027	28 Days / 27 Nights	Maximum 12 Guests	US$33,850

HIGHLIGHTS

Twenty-seven nights to explore, wait and stay with the moment

01

27 Nights Aboard Meridian

A long-format expedition with enough time to move beyond a quick Antarctic overview.

02

Only 12 Guests

The entire vessel is chartered for a small group, keeping the experience personal and flexible.

03

Early Antarctic Summer

Active penguin colonies, seals, returning whales and dramatic ice at the opening of the season.

04

Daily Field Time

Zodiac excursions, shore landings and wildlife scouting whenever conditions allow.

05

Flexible Routing

The captain and expedition team can respond to weather, wildlife, sea ice and the best available light.

06

Martin Gregus

Photography workshops, field guidance, presentations, image reviews and storytelling sessions.

ABOUT THE EXPERIENCE

Let the ice, wildlife and light set the pace

Antarctica is not a place you can force into a schedule. The ice moves, the weather decides, and the wildlife reveals itself only when the moment is right.

This 27-night expedition aboard Meridian is built around that truth. With the entire vessel chartered for just 12 guests, the route can flex around weather, light and wildlife.

Early December marks the beginning of the Antarctic summer. Penguin colonies are alive with activity, seals move through the ice, whales begin returning to feeding grounds, and the landscape still carries the raw feeling of the season opening.

Martin brings the patience of a wildlife photographer to every day in the field. This is about learning to read the ice, understand animal behaviour, wait for the right light and experience Antarctica with the time it deserves.



"To be in the presence of a unique visionary like Martin Gregus and be welcomed into his home away from home in the middle of nowhere is truly a once in a lifetime event right up there with getting married or having a child."

Anne Prather · United States

YOUR STORYTELLER GUIDE

Martin Gregus



Martin Gregus

WILDLIFE PHOTOGRAPHER AND CINEMATOGRAPHER

Martin Gregus grew up in Bratislava, Slovakia, in a household full of artists. He learned photography from his father and was exploring local wildlife with a camera before most kids had decided what they wanted to do with their lives.

His work has taken him across all seven continents and some of the most remote ecosystems on the planet. He has earned two wins and two nominations at Wildlife Photographer of the Year, and his polar bear project, 33 Days Among the Bears, became an international story after National Geographic coverage.

His cinematography has contributed to productions for Disney, BBC and Netflix. In the field, Martin teaches patience, preparation and how to read wildlife, weather and light.

20+	200+	7	730k+
years of experience	global expeditions	continents explored	social followers



WHY THIS TRIP?

A floating field camp, not a rushed cruise

The value of this expedition is time. Twenty-seven nights create room to stay longer when conditions are extraordinary, move toward quieter coastline and let wildlife behaviour shape the day.

With only 12 guests, Martin can work closely with photographers and wildlife lovers alike. The group can learn from each sighting instead of racing through a fixed checklist.

This is still true expedition travel. Landings, routes and wildlife encounters depend on weather, ice, safety and permissions. That uncertainty is part of what makes Antarctica real.








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DAY BY DAY

Your 28-day Antarctic expedition

DAY 1

Embark Meridian

EXPEDITION

Board at the confirmed departure port, settle into your cabin and meet Martin, your additional guide and the expedition team. After safety briefings and dinner onboard, the voyage begins.

DAYS 2–4

South Across the Southern Ocean

EXPEDITION

Settle into life at sea with wildlife scouting, photography briefings, seabirds from the deck and preparation for Antarctic conditions.

DAYS 5–8

First Ice and First Landings

EXPEDITION

Conditions allowing, begin Zodiac cruising and shore landings among penguin colonies, glacier fronts, sculpted ice and the early signs of summer.

DAYS 9–18

Deep Antarctic Exploration

EXPEDITION

Follow the best windows for wildlife, light and ice. Days may bring Zodiac cruises, shore landings, penguins, seals, whale scouting and field guidance with Martin.

DAYS 19–24

Wildlife, Light and Remote Coastline

EXPEDITION

Stay longer when conditions are exceptional or move toward quieter bays. Expect patient observation, image reviews and the unpredictability that makes Antarctica powerful.

DAYS 25–27

The Return Crossing

EXPEDITION

Head north across the Southern Ocean with editing sessions, presentations, final image reviews and time to reflect on nearly four weeks in Antarctic waters.

DAY 28

Return from the White Continent

EXPEDITION

Arrive at the confirmed port and disembark after breakfast. Final joining details will be supplied before guests book travel.



YOUR EXPEDITION BASE

Twenty-seven nights aboard Meridian

Meridian is the base for wildlife scouting, daily briefings, shared meals, workshops and the crossings that connect each landing opportunity.

The full vessel is chartered for a maximum of 12 guests. This gives the expedition team room to adapt the route and creates more direct time with Martin.

The final embarkation and disembarkation port is still to be confirmed. Exact joining details will be supplied before guests book travel.

27	12	28	1
nights aboard Meridian	guest maximum	days of expedition travel	private vessel charter

THE DETAILS

What is included

Included

- 27 nights aboard Meridian
- All meals and beverages onboard
- Daily Zodiac excursions and shore landings where conditions allow
- Professional expedition guides
- Photography workshops and presentations with Martin Gregus
- Evening image reviews and storytelling sessions
- Airport and vessel transfers where applicable
- All planned excursions and activities
- Dedicated Airguides expedition leader

Not Included

- International and domestic flights
- Hotels before or after the expedition
- Travel insurance, including medical evacuation cover
- Visa or transit fees where applicable
- Personal camera equipment and personal expenses
- Crew gratuities
- Costs caused by weather or travel delays

Final routes, landings and wildlife encounters depend on weather, sea, ice, safety and local permissions.

FAQ

What guests usually need to know

Where does the expedition start and finish?

The final embarkation and disembarkation port is still to be confirmed. Guests will receive exact joining details before booking travel.

Is the itinerary or wildlife guaranteed?

No. The route is shaped each day by safety, weather, ice, wildlife activity and landing permissions. Wildlife encounters and shore landings cannot be guaranteed.

Can I join if I am not a photographer?

Yes. Martin supports photographers at every level, but the expedition is equally suited to wildlife lovers and adventurous travellers who want to experience Antarctica deeply.

What fitness level is required?

Guests should be comfortable stepping in and out of Zodiacs, walking on uneven or snowy ground and spending time outside in cold, wet and windy conditions.

Why travel in early December?

The opening of the Antarctic summer brings active penguin colonies, seals moving through the ice and whales beginning to return to feeding grounds. Conditions remain wild and changeable.

PRICING AND DATES

Reserve your place with Airguides

TRIP PRICE

US$33,850

Per person in USD for the confirmed departure.

DEPOSIT

US$3,750

Per person in USD to reserve your place.

27 November - 24 December 2027 (Confirmed)

Trip price, deposit, availability, payment schedule and final inclusions should be confirmed with Airguides at the time of booking.

READY?

Twenty-seven nights. Twelve guests. Antarctica with time on your side.

Get in touch to check availability, confirm final joining details and secure your place with a deposit.

Secure Your Spot

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